

is that you meet a lot of interesting people from all over the world. I am always impressed by all the people who give their own specific and individual contributions back to the project.

Q Do you have plans to involve more developers from India?

Sure. Have you heard about the new mentoring pilot program of Apache for India ([ICFOSHttp://community.apache.org/mentoringprogramme-icfoss-pilot.html](http://icfosshttp://community.apache.org/mentoringprogramme-icfoss-pilot.html))? This is a new program for undergraduates and graduate students who have an interest in learning how to participate in open source communities at ASF.

We are always interested in growing in all areas and developers, especially, are needed. I see a huge opportunity here for students to participate actively in the project and learn how to develop with and for OpenOffice. Office functionality is commonly used in most enterprises, and it often requires a lot of licence costs to run the business. OpenOffice is a useful and good free alternative; students can even think of running their own businesses based on OpenOffice, offering support and services. It would really help if you are able to fix a bug on your own. Experience and competence is key here, and can help to run a business based on this huge and well-known open source project. We are working to extend OpenOffice to work closer and better with other software systems, and to improve interoperability with Microsoft.

Developers should think about what they want to achieve and what they want to do. OpenOffice can be a very interesting place to grow in any direction and can help to increase personal knowledge and experience. With over 60 million downloads in one year, we are really successful and this alone should be motivation - making your work available to millions of users. 

About Juergen

Juergen Schmidt works for IBM in the Collaboration Solutions department and his main focus is the Apache OpenOffice project. He has worked with the project since 1997 when he started to work for StarDivision, and later for Sun and Oracle. Before the project moved in 2011 under the umbrella of the Apache Software Foundation, he was a member of the OpenOffice.org Community Council and the project lead of the API and Extensions project. One aspect of his daily work is community building and helping to drive the project forward. His passion is to spread knowledge about the programmability features of OpenOffice around the world and to show that it is a lot more than just an office productivity suite. Juergen Schmidt frequently speaks about OpenOffice at various national and international conferences.

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